

HIKESUPPLY CO.

Kids Trail Explorer Pack

Scavenger hunts for every season, trail bingo and a junior hiker journal. Made for little legs and curious eyes, ages 4 to 10.

24 PRINTABLE PAGES 3 LEVELS LETTER + A4

FOR GROWN-UPS

How to use this pack

Kids walk farther and happier when they have a mission. Hand them a hunt sheet at the trailhead and the hike becomes a search, not a march.

Pick the right level

LEVEL	BEST FOR	HOW IT WORKS
Easy	Ages 4 to 5	Nine big pictures. No reading needed. Spot it, tick the box.
Tricky	Ages 6 to 7	Twelve picture clues with short words to read together.
Expert	Ages 8 to 10	Ten challenges to count, compare, listen, draw and write.

Ages are a guide. Let siblings swap levels, or team a reader with a younger spotter.

What is inside

- [ ] Kid trail rules and Leave No Trace in kid words
- [ ] Four seasonal hunts, three levels each
- [ ] Trail bingo, a five senses walk, a sign spotter
- [ ] Journal pages, a hike map page, a hike counter
- [ ] A Junior Trail Explorer certificate

Printing tips

Print at Actual size on US Letter. An A4 file and a low-ink printer-friendly file are included.

Card stock works well for bingo and the certificate. A clipboard and a crayon or pencil make the hunt easy on the move.

Reprint the hunts and journal pages as often as you like for your own family.

Spot it, don't take it

Every hunt is a looking game. Nothing gets picked, collected or taken home. Kids tick the box, then leave the leaf, cone or rock for the next family. Many parks do not allow collecting at all.

Before you go: choose a short trail the slowest walker can finish, check the weather and park alerts, and pack water, snacks and layers. Give each child a whistle and practice the trail rules on page 3 at home. Take a photo of your child at the trailhead so you know exactly what they are wearing today. Do a tick check after the hike.

READ TOGETHER BEFORE EVERY HIKE

My trail rules



Stay where you can see your grown-up

If you cannot see them, stop and call out. Grown-ups lead or follow, kids stay in the middle.



Stop at every trail sign and fork

Wait there for your group, even if you know the way. Pick the path together.



Stay on the trail

Trails keep you safe and protect plants. No shortcuts, even when it looks quicker.



Look, don't touch or taste

Never eat berries, mushrooms or plants from the trail. Leave animals and their homes alone.



Leaves of three, let it be

Poison ivy can have three shiny or dull leaves. Do not touch plants you do not know.



If you are lost, hug a tree

Stop. Stay in one place by a tree, even if you are scared. People will come to find you. Staying still makes you easier to find.



Blow your whistle three times

Three blows means "I need help." Wait, then blow three times again. When you hear someone call your name, shout back. You are not in trouble.

Practice at home: play "hug a tree" in the yard or a park. Your child picks a tree, stays put and blows the whistle while you walk over.

Explorer: _____

LEAVE NO TRACE FOR KIDS

Seven trail promises

Good explorers leave the trail just as nice as they found it, so animals stay healthy and the next family can enjoy it too.



PROMISE 1

Plan with your grown-up

Look at the map before you go. Pack water, a snack, a jacket and your whistle.



PROMISE 2

Stay on the path

Walk on the trail, even through puddles and mud, so plants on the sides can keep growing.



PROMISE 3

Pack out every crumb

Everything you bring comes home with you. Wrappers, apple cores and peels too.



PROMISE 4

Leave what you find

Rocks, cones, flowers and feathers stay on the trail. Take a picture or draw them instead.



PROMISE 5

Be careful with fire

Only grown-ups make fires, only where it is allowed. Never play with matches.



PROMISE 6

Watch animals from far away

Be quiet and still. Never feed wild animals, not even a tiny crumb. People food makes them sick.



PROMISE 7

Share the trail kindly

Say hi, step aside to let people pass, and use your quiet trail voice so everyone can hear the birds.

My promise

I will follow the seven trail promises on every hike.

Sign your name

Based on the seven Leave No Trace principles, written here in kid words. Learn more at lnt.org.

FALL HUNT

Fall: Easy

LEVEL ● ○ ○

Find each thing and tick its box. Leave everything where it is.

☐



Red leaf

☐



Yellow leaf

☐



Acorn

☐



Pinecone

☐



Mushroom

look, don't touch

☐



Squirrel

☐



Feather

☐



Big rock

☐



Spider web

Spot it, leave it. Take a photo instead of a leaf, so the next family can find it too.

I found ____ of 9

FALL HUNT

Fall: Tricky

LEVEL ●●○

Read each clue with your grown-up. Tick it when you spot it.

- ☐  A leaf with **pointy edges**
- ☐  A leaf **bigger than your hand**
- ☐  A seed with a **wing** that spins
- ☐  An acorn with its **cap still on**
- ☐  A **bird nest** in a branch
- ☐  Birds flying in a **V shape**
- ☐  **Moss** on a log or rock
- ☐  A stick shaped like a **letter**
- ☐  Something that **smells** like fall
- ☐  A tree with **bumpy bark**
- ☐  An animal **carrying food**
- ☐  Animal **tracks** in mud

Wear bright colors in fall. Hunters may be out in some places, and bright clothes are easy to see.

I found _____ of 12

FALL HUNT

Fall: Expert

LEVEL ●●●

Big explorers only. Answer each fall challenge on the trail, then count how many you finished.

1 Find leaves in five different colors. Color in one dot for each.

◯ ◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

2 Find a leaf with points, like a maple leaf. How many points does it have?

_____

3 Look for a pile of chewed pinecone pieces. Squirrels leave these where they eat.

☐ Found it ☐ Not today

4 Watch a bird for one minute. What is it doing?

☐ Walking ☐ Hopping ☐ Flying ☐ Eating

5 Find a mushroom. Look only, never touch or taste. What color is the top?

_____

6 Find a seed that rides the wind and one that sticks to socks or fur.

☐ Wind seed ☐ Sticky seed

7 Stand still and listen for one minute. How many different bird sounds?

_____

8 Find the oldest-looking tree. Can your arms reach all the way around it?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Almost

9 Count your steps from one trail sign or marker to the next.

_____ steps

10 Draw your favorite leaf shape on the back of this page.

☐ Done

Expert tip: Use a pencil so you can fix mistakes, and save the drawing for your snack stop.

I found _____ of 10

WINTER HUNT

Winter: Easy

LEVEL ● ○ ○

Find each thing and tick its box. No snow? Look for frost and cold puddles.

☐



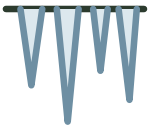
Evergreen tree

☐



Snow or frost

☐



Icicle

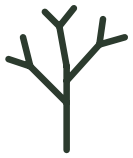
look from a safe spot

☐



Animal tracks

☐



Bare tree

☐



Pinecone

☐



A bird

☐



Your foggy breath

☐



Red berries

look, don't eat

Stay warm: hat, mittens and dry socks. Tell your grown-up if your fingers or toes hurt from the cold.

I found ____ of 9

WINTER HUNT

Winter: Tricky

LEVEL ●●○

Read each clue with your grown-up. Never stand under big icicles.

- ☐  Tracks from **two different** animals
- ☐  A **nest** you can see in a bare tree
- ☐  A **woodpecker hole** in a trunk
- ☐  A **frozen** puddle
- ☐  A tree that is **still green**
- ☐  A pinecone on the **snow or ground**
- ☐  **Frost** or a snowflake up close
- ☐  Sun shining through **bare branches**
- ☐  An icicle **longer than your finger**
- ☐  A bird **puffed up** to stay warm
- ☐  **Green moss** in winter
- ☐  Mittens or gloves on **every hiker**

Days are short in winter. Start early and turn around with plenty of daylight left.

I found ____ of 12

WINTER HUNT

Winter: Expert

LEVEL ●●●

Big explorers only. Answer each winter challenge on the trail, then count how many you finished.

1 Find animal tracks. Follow them with your eyes only, from the trail. Which way did it go?

☐ Left ☐ Right ☐ Ahead ☐ Back

2 Find an evergreen. Do its needles grow in little bunches or one by one?

☐ Bunches ☐ One by one

3 Trees make buds in fall and wait for spring. Count the buds on one twig.

_____

4 Find a spot where the snow or frost melted first. Why there?

_____

5 Find woodpecker holes. Are they round or long and rectangle-shaped?

☐ Round ☐ Rectangle ☐ Both

6 If there is snow, push a stick in to measure it.

_____ in / _____ cm

7 Find three things that are still green in winter.

◯ ◯ ◯

8 Stand still and listen. Do you hear birds, wind, water or crunching snow?

☐ Birds ☐ Wind ☐ Water ☐ Snow

9 Blow a breath cloud. Count how long until it disappears.

_____ seconds

10 Draw a snowflake or a frost pattern on the back of this page.

☐ Done

Expert tip: Keep moving to stay warm, and head back before anyone gets too cold.

I found _____ of 10

SPRING HUNT

Spring: Easy

LEVEL ● ○ ○

Find each thing and tick its box. Leave every flower growing.

☐



Flower

☐



New sprout

☐



Worm

☐



Puddle

☐



Singing bird

☐



Butterfly

☐



Bee

look, don't touch

☐



Fern

☐



Rain cloud

Flowers stay in the ground. Look close, smell gently, and leave them for bees and butterflies.

I found ____ of 9

SPRING HUNT

Spring: Tricky

LEVEL ●●○

Read each clue with your grown-up. Tick it when you spot it.

- ☐  A fern **unrolling**, curled like a snail
- ☐  Wildflowers in **three colors**
- ☐  A bird **carrying** grass or twigs
- ☐  A tree with **flowers** on it
- ☐  A bee **visiting** a flower
- ☐  A **footprint** in the mud
- ☐  Tiny **new leaves** on a branch
- ☐  A stream **full from rain**
- ☐  A **snail** or a slug
- ☐  **Frog songs** near water
- ☐  **Leaves of three**. Point, don't touch!
- ☐  A web with **water drops**

Baby animal season. If you see a baby animal alone, leave it. Its parent is usually nearby.

I found _____ of 12

SPRING HUNT

Spring: Expert

LEVEL ●●●

Big explorers only. Answer each spring challenge on the trail, then count how many you finished.

1 Find a wildflower and count its petals. Leave it growing.

_____

2 Listen near water. Do the frogs peep, croak or trill?

☐ Peep ☐ Croak ☐ Trill ☐ None

3 Find a leaf bud. Draw it on the back. Come back in two weeks and draw it again.

☐ Today ☐ Two weeks

4 Spot a bird building a nest. What is it carrying?

_____

5 Find poison ivy from a safe distance and point it out to your grown-up.

☐ Spotted it ☐ None here

6 Find five different shades of green. Color one dot for each.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

7 Find a pollinator on a flower. Which one?

☐ Bee ☐ Butterfly ☐ Beetle ☐ Fly

8 Find a track near a puddle or in mud. Who made it?

_____

9 Find something that was not here in winter.

_____

10 After rain, smell the air. Describe the smell in three words.

_____

Expert tip: Muddy trail? Walk through the middle of the mud, not around it, so the trail does not get wider.

I found _____ of 10

SUMMER HUNT

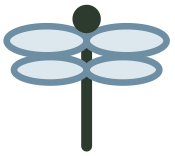
Summer: Easy

LEVEL ● ○ ○

Find each thing and tick its box. Take a water break in the shade.

☐ 

Butterfly

☐ 

Dragonfly

☐ 

Wildflower

☐ 

Ant

☐ 

Fluffy cloud

☐ 

Shady tree

☐ 

Stream

☐ 

A bird

☐ 

Clover

Look, don't eat. Some berries look tasty but can make you very sick.

I found ____ of 9

SUMMER HUNT

Summer: Tricky

LEVEL ●●○

Read each clue with your grown-up. Tick it when you spot it.

- ☐  A dragonfly **resting**
- ☐  A line of ants **marching**
- ☐  A cloud shaped like an **animal**
- ☐  **Cool shade** under a big tree
- ☐  A butterfly with **spots**
- ☐  Berries on a bush. **Never eat!**
- ☐  A **beetle** on a leaf
- ☐  A rock with **stripes** or lines
- ☐  A **feather** on the ground
- ☐  A **frog** or a **lizard**
- ☐  A **bridge** or stepping stones
- ☐  A **firefly** on an evening walk

Sun safety: hat on, sunscreen on, water bottle full before you leave.

I found ____ of 12

SUMMER HUNT

Summer: Expert

LEVEL ●●●

Big explorers only. Answer each summer challenge on the trail, then count how many you finished.

1 Find four different kinds of insects. Color a dot for each.

◯ ◯ ◯ ◯

2 Find the coolest spot on the trail. Why is it cool there?

_____

3 Watch an ant trail. How many ants pass one spot while you count to 30?

_____

4 Lie back (on a dry spot on the trail) and watch the clouds. Draw one on the back.

☐ Done

5 Find a flower that is not yellow or white. What color is it?

_____

6 Find tracks in dust, sand or dry mud. Who made them?

_____

7 Count butterflies and dragonflies for five minutes.

_____ butterflies _____ dragonflies

8 Find a clue that an animal ate here: a chewed leaf, nut shells or a hole in a leaf.

_____

9 Name three sounds you hear that are not made by people.

_____

10 How did you stay cool today?

☐ Water ☐ Hat ☐ Shade ☐ Sunscreen

Expert tip: Hot day? Sip water often, wear a hat and sunscreen, and rest in the shade.

I found _____ of 10

ANY SEASON, ANY TRAIL

Trail bingo

Cross off each square when you spot it. Five in a row in any direction is BINGO. Fill the whole card for a super bingo.

T	R	A	I	L
 Evergreen	 A bird	 Big rock	 Water	 Trail sign
 Green leaf	 A bug	 Bridge	 Y-shaped stick	 Cloud
 Fallen log	 Moss	**FREE You are hiking!**	 Tracks	 Flower or bud
 Cone or seed	 Spider web	 Other hikers	 Sunny spot	 Feather
 Huge tree	 Pile of rocks	 Furry animal	 Puddle or mud	 Dead tree

Play together: print one card per kid. First to shout BINGO picks the snack break spot.

Bingos: _____

SLOW DOWN AND NOTICE

Five senses walk

Find a safe spot beside the trail. Stop, breathe, and use one sense at a time. Write or draw what you notice.



5 things I can see

Look up, look down, look far away.



4 things I can hear

Close your eyes and count to ten first.



3 things I can touch

Bark, a smooth rock, cool water. Only safe things your grown-up says are OK.



2 things I can smell

Pine needles, wet soil, flowers, rain.



1 thing I can taste

Your trail snack! Never taste plants or berries from the trail.

Great for tired legs. A senses stop is a rest that feels like a game.

Date: _____

READ THE TRAIL

Trail sign and blaze spotter

Trails talk to hikers with signs and marks. Learn what they mean, then keep a tally of every one you spot.

Trail blaze

A painted mark on a tree or rock. It means you are on the trail. Each trail has its own color or shape.

TALLY

Turn ahead

Two blazes, one above the other, mean the trail turns soon. On many trails the top one leans the way to go.

TALLY

Junction sign

Where trails meet. It shows trail names, arrows and how far to go. Stop here and wait for your group.

TALLY

Trailhead map

The big board at the start. Find the dot that says You Are Here before you set off.

TALLY

Rock pile (cairn)

Some trails over rock use piles of stones as markers. Never add rocks or knock them down.

TALLY

Mile or km marker

A small post with a number. Some trails count miles, some count kilometers.

TALLY

Draw the blaze on your trail today

MY TRAIL'S BLAZE

ITS COLOR AND SHAPE

Good to know: blaze colors and shapes are different from park to park. Check the map at the trailhead to learn yours.

JUNIOR HIKER JOURNAL

My hike

HIKE NUMBER _____

DATE _____

TRAIL NAME _____

HOW FAR _____ mi / _____ km

WHO CAME WITH ME _____

THE WEATHER WAS (CIRCLE ONE)



Sunny Cloudy Rainy Snowy Cold

I FELT (CIRCLE ONE)



Amazing Happy Okay Tired Wow!

DRAW THE BEST THING I SAW

ANIMALS AND PLANTS I SAW

THE BEST PART

THE HARDEST PART

NEXT TIME I WANT TO

My hike

HIKE NUMBER _____

DATE

TRAIL NAME

HOW FAR mi / km

WHO CAME WITH ME

THE WEATHER WAS (CIRCLE ONE)



Sunny Cloudy Rainy Snowy Cold

I FELT (CIRCLE ONE)



Amazing Happy Okay Tired Wow!

DRAW THE BEST THING I SAW

ANIMALS AND PLANTS I SAW

THE BEST PART

THE HARDEST PART

NEXT TIME I WANT TO

Draw a map of my hike

Draw the path you walked from start to finish. Add the things you passed, using the little pictures in the key.

TRAIL NAME _____ DATE _____

MY MAP

N

MAP KEY

- Start and finish
- Bridge
- Water
- Big tree
- Big rock
- Animal I saw
- Snack stop
- Top or lookout

STEPS OR DISTANCE _____ mi / _____ km

TIME ON THE TRAIL _____

KEEP COUNT

My hike counter

After every hike, put a sticker on the next circle or color it in. Circled numbers are milestones, so plan a little celebration with your grown-up.

1	2	3	4	**5**	6	7	8	9	**10**
11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	**25**	26	27	28	29	30
31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40
41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49	**50**

5 hikes

Trail Starter. You pick the snack for the next hike.

10 hikes

Trail Spotter. You choose the next trail from the map.

25 hikes

Trail Leader. You lead the group for part of a hike.

50 hikes

Trail Explorer. Time for your certificate on the next page!

My favorite trails so far

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

LONGEST HIKE _____ mi / _____ km

TOTAL DISTANCE _____ mi / _____ km

Handy to know: 1 mile is about 1.6 kilometers. 1 kilometer is about 0.6 miles.

HIKESUPPLY CO.



OFFICIAL AWARD

Junior Trail Explorer

This certificate is proudly given to

_____

for exploring the trail with sharp eyes and a brave heart, finishing _____ hikes and _____ scavenger hunts, and keeping all seven trail promises.

☐ Trail rules expert ☐ Bingo winner ☐ Hug-a-tree ready

_____ DATE

_____ SIGNED BY MY TRAIL BUDDY